



good performance in this application area was the Dart Emerald, featuring a 2 GHz Pentium 4 processor with 256 MB of DDR RAM. Since the PC was well geared with a powerful processor and RAM, even with onboard graphics, it managed a very impressive score in the Photoshop test, where it sped through the 21 test filters in just 16 seconds. The 17-inch flat screen monitor produced crisp and vivid images even at high resolutions and refresh rates, making it suited to serious multimedia and productivity applications. In the video encoding tests, the powerful processor enabled it to process the test video file in just 1 minute 15 seconds.

Office and Internet: In this application area, we evaluated the performance of the computers in relatively non-taxing applications such as office suites and Internet browsing. The specific subsystem that decided the performance of the computer here was the processor, the RAM, the hard disk, the CD-ROM drive, monitor and also the speaker and soundcard. Therefore, a higher weightage was given to the SiSoft Sandra subsystem tests, monitor, CD-ROM, the soundcard and the speaker tests. In fact, if you are looking for a computer that is suited to simple office applications, you need to just look at the processor, RAM and hard disk.

Compaq Presario 3705AP

This good-looking computer comprises a 1.7 GHz Pentium 4 processor, 128 MB of DDR RAM, a Maxtor 40 GB hard disk and a very clear and sharp 15-inch monitor. Another very good addition is the JBL Platinum Series speakers that render pleasant sound quality. The chic black colour and the overall design aesthetics make the system stand out in a crowd. The cabinet features a tool-free construction and provides two USB ports on the front panel with audio connections for the mic and headphones. The Compaq Presario 3705AP also bundles a 10/100 base



Ethernet card and a Conexant 56K PCI modem. An AGP port is provided so that the graphics subsystem can be enhanced with a faster graphics card. On the software front, it comes preloaded with Windows XP Home Edition and the necessary driver CDs are also provided along with a recovery CD. The package includes a host of anti-virus, multimedia and educational applications. This was one of the few brands that offered

telephonic support and at Rs 50,363 is a good choice for users who like appealing looks and upgradability.

Suitability to Task Index

Gaming	5.64
Productivity	6.15
Office apps/Internet	6.14

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